

Vibe Coding in India

I saw young students solving real-world problems with vibe coding

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“Vibe coding” is a term that we’ve heard a lot since the rise of AI. Essentially, it has reduced the entry barrier for getting into programming, as the user commands the AI, which then codes based on the prompt. While this type of practice has seen a rise among university students and working professionals, something that wasn’t expected was seeing young school students getting into it, too.

With AI becoming accessible to people around the globe, it is also important that the future generation understands its usage too. Keeping the same thought in check, Schoolnet, an edutech company, recently concluded its Ecoinnovators Ideathon 2026 event. Conducted in collaboration with the Global Learning Council, the entire concept of the event was very interesting.

Energy at Ecoinnovators

The students from grades 8 to 12 were given a simple task. They had to find solutions to make the Earth sustainable, using AI. But the interesting thing was that none of them had any prior coding experience. All the projects were made by using vibe coding!

Instead of traditional IDEs filled with thousands of lines of code, the presentations showed screens that had natural language prompts. It certainly shows how young students are the early adopters of a new world, where human logic is the only remaining bottleneck.

The entry barrier disappears

Something that was noticeable during the event was that most of the teams were quite aware of all the AI tools and services popular today. All the projects

featured in the event used vibe coding platforms like Lovable, Bolt, and Cursor, and while chatting with the students, all of them expressed how easy it was to use all these tools.

All in all, it is safe to say that thanks to these advancements, the barrier to creating software has disappeared, as long as someone has a vision, all because of vibe coding. Most of these young students told us how they did not interact with raw code much. Their primary interactions were prompting for changes, testing prototypes, and debugging through the dialogue. This shift allows students to focus on “the why” and “the what” rather than “the how”.

Schoolnet CEO expresses his thoughts on the ideathon

Speaking to Digit at the event, Mr. RCM Reddy, MD & CEO, Schoolnet India, expressed his thoughts on the Ideathon.

He said, “The whole objective of this hackathon is that to encourage the students to use tech like AI to design apps, games, to address environmental challenges like air pollution, waste management, energy conservation.”

Furthermore, he also said, “The benefits of such a challenge and competition are that students will have skills, they will have understanding to use technology to solve any of the real-world environmental challenges.”

The opportunity does not end there for the students, as Mr. Reddy further explained that the winners selected from the competition would be getting a chance to go to Villars, Symposium in Switzerland, this year in June to make a presentation to the global audience.

Shift from “how” to “what”

As 2026 unfolds, it is clear to say that for India’s youth, coding is no longer a skill that they need to master, due to the rise of Vibe Coding.

As seen at the Ecoinnovators Ideathon, they built some wonderful projects. Rather than having strong coding knowledge, the winners in the competition had the clearest vision instead. 

